

FUTURE SKILLS SERIES

FREE

AI Literacy • Lesson 1 of 6

THE LITERAL GENIE LESSON

How to Talk to AI

AI grants what you SAID,
not what you MEANT.

Grades 6–8

45-min lesson

No prep • No devices needed



STUDENT SESSION

Cursed Wish Repair Shop



Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

The genie's one rule: it grants exactly what you SAID — never what you MEANT. A **cursed wish** can be twisted. A **genie-proof** wish can't, because it has all three **P.R.O.** parts:

- **P — Purpose:** what you want + who it's for
- **R — Requirements:** at least 2 rules, like length, tone, format, or what to include or leave out
- **O — Output:** what the finished answer should look like (a list? a table? a paragraph?)



CURSED WISH #1 — AMARA'S SPACE POSTER

Amara's science poster is due Friday. She typed *"tell me about space."* The genie handed her 40 pages on the history of NASA. Rewrite her wish so the genie can't twist it. Use P, R, and O:



CURSED WISH #2 — MATEO'S HEADPHONE FUND

Mateo gets \$5 a week and wants \$120 headphones. He typed *"help me save money."* The genie answered: "Stop buying things." Rewrite his wish. Use P, R, and O:



CURSED WISH #3 — YUKI'S HERO STORY

Yuki wants an anime-style story for the class magazine. She typed *"make a story about a hero."* The genie wrote: "Once there was a hero. The end." Rewrite her wish. Use P, R, and O:

THE LITERAL GENIE LESSON • LESSON 1 OF 6

How to Talk to AI



45 minutes, no prep. The hook: AI is a literal genie — it grants what you SAID, not what you MEANT. Students learn the two human jobs in a good AI task: the prompt and the check. Stands alone.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min	Cursed Wish Repair Shop worksheet (2 pages, 1 per student; typeable PDF included) • Slides (optional) • board for P.R.O. • Teacher Guide (Scoring Guidance, P.R.O. sentence starters) • pens	None — runs fully unplugged. Optional: a projector for the slides; one AI tool (ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini) on your screen for the Showcase.	Print worksheets (and Teacher Guide p.3 if you use the Support/ELL sentence starters). That's it.

OBJECTIVES

ISTE 1.5.c

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA W.6.4

- Show how a vague prompt lets the genie choose (and why that produces a worse answer). (Exit Ticket #1, part two)
- Apply **P.R.O.** (Purpose, Requirements, Output) to write a clear prompt. (Wish repairs 1–3; Exit Ticket #1)
- Evaluate a sample AI answer: pick what to double-check and name a resource. (Exit Ticket #2)

♦ WARM-UP — THE WORST GENIE EVER (8 MIN)

You are a genie who grants wishes *exactly as worded*. Takes 3–4 wishes and ruin every one, cheerfully:

"I wish I was rich." → "Done. Your name is now rich."
 "I wish for a million dollars." → "Granted. One million dollars, in play money."
 "I wish school was over." → "Granted. The school building is now over... there."
 "I wish I was the best gamer alive." → "Granted. You are now the only gamer alive."

Then ask: "What the fault was that — the genie's, or the wish's?" **Bridge:** "AI works like that genie. It can't see what you MEANT. It only sees what you SAID, and it guesses the rest. A good AI job goes human, human: you start it with the wish, the genie does the middle, and you check what comes back. Today you get good at both human parts."

What if a wish is inappropriate? Don't play it: "The genie doesn't grant that one. Next wish." Nobody volunteers? Wish first yourself: "I wish for a snack" → "Granted: one grain of rice."

Transition: "So how do you write a wish a genie can't twist? You leave it no wiggle room."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION — PARTS OF A GENIE-PROOF WISH (10 MIN)

"Every genie-proof wish has three parts." Write **P.R.O.** on the board as you go:

P — Purpose. What you want + who it's for. "Explain photosynthesis to a 6th grader" beats "explain photosynthesis."

R — Requirements. The rules: length, tone, format, include / leave out. This is what stops the twist.

O — Output. What should the finished answer look like? A list? A paragraph? A table? A plan?

Watch one get fixed — build the repair on the board, naming each part as you add it. **Cursed wish:** "help with my history essay" → **Genie-proof P.R.O. prompt:** "I'm writing a 7th grade history essay on the printing press. Give me 3 thesis statements and 2 pieces of evidence for each, as a bullet list. Don't write it for me." With devices: run it live.

◆ THE AI-HONESTY DISCUSSION (USE ANYTIME IT COMES UP)

Q: "Is using AI cheating?" — One line does the work: *AI is your editor, not your ghostwriter.* Feedback, brainstorming, checking understanding = editor. Handing in its work with your name on it = ghostwriter. Ask: "What did YOU make?"

Q: "Is the AI always right?" — No. It predicts likely words, so it can be confidently wrong ("hallucinate"), like a trickster genie. The lesson's rule of thumb: *A name, a date, a number: if you can check it, check it somewhere real before you use it.* Quotes count too. (Lesson 3 in the unit, Hallucination Hunters, goes deep on this.)

Q: "Will AI take all the jobs?" — Say it straight: nobody knows yet. So far, AI mostly takes over tasks, not whole jobs. People who can direct an AI clearly and check what it hands back will likely have an edge. That's today's lesson.

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: P.R.O. instruction (a prompt broken into Purpose / Requirements / Output). Assessed: the three wish repairs (worksheet p.1) and Exit Ticket #1, scored with the Scoring Guidance above.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: the trickster rule that opens the Exit Ticket block and the "Is the AI always right?" discussion. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 — student evaluate a printed sample AI answer, underline the sentence they would double-check, and name a real source to check it.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1-3 above.) *Taught: the Purpose part (task + audience) and the Requirements part (style, length, tone). Assessed: wish repairs 1–3 + Exit Ticket #1.*

SUPPORT & ELL: P.R.O. SENTENCE STARTERS

P: "I am a ____ grader working on _____. I want ____ for _____."

R: "Keep it ____ (length). Use a ____ tone. Include _____. Do NOT _____."

O: "Give me the answer as a ____ (list / table / paragraph / steps)."

Support students may repair two wishes instead of three. ELL students may draft in their strongest language first, then translate — the starters double as language frames.

◆ THANK YOU & TERMS OF USE

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